

Python - Escape Characters

Escape Character

An **escape character** is a character followed by a backslash (\). It tells the **Interpreter** that this escape character (sequence) has a special meaning. For instance, \n is an escape sequence that represents a newline. When Python encounters this sequence in a string, it understands that it needs to start a new line.

Unless an 'r' or 'R' prefix is present, escape sequences in string and bytes literals are interpreted according to rules similar to those used by Standard C. In Python, a **string** becomes a raw string if it is prefixed with "r" or "R" before the quotation symbols. Hence 'Hello' is a normal string whereas r'Hello' is a raw string.

Example

In the below example, we are practically demonstrating raw and normal string.

```
# normal string
normal = "Hello"
print (normal)

# raw string
raw = r"Hello"
print (raw)
```

Output of the above code is shown below –

```
Hello
```

Hello

In normal circumstances, there is no difference between the two. However, when the escape character is embedded in the string, the normal string actually interprets the escape sequence, whereas the raw string doesn't process the escape character.

Example

In the following example, when a normal string is printed the escape character '\n' is processed to introduce a newline. However, because of the raw string operator 'r' the effect of escape character is not translated as per its meaning.

```
normal = "Hello\nWorld"
print (normal)

raw = r"Hello\nWorld"
print (raw)
```

On running the above code, it will print the following result –

```
Hello
World
Hello\nWorld
```

Escape Characters in Python

The following table shows the different escape characters used in Python -

Sr.No	Escape Sequence & Meaning
1	\<newline> Backslash and newline ignored
2	\\ Backslash (\)
3	\' Single quote (')
4	\"

	Double quote (")
5	\a ASCII Bell (BEL)
6	\b ASCII Backspace (BS)
7	\f ASCII Formfeed (FF)
8	\n ASCII Linefeed (LF)
9	\r ASCII Carriage Return (CR)
10	\t ASCII Horizontal Tab (TAB)
11	\v ASCII Vertical Tab (VT)
12	\ooo Character with octal value ooo
13	\xhh Character with hex value hh

Escape Characters Example

The following code shows the usage of escape sequences listed in the above table –

```
# ignore \
s = 'This string will not include \
backslashes or newline characters.'
print (s)

# escape backslash
s=s = 'The \\character is called backslash'
print (s)

# escape single quote
```

```

s='Hello \'Python\''
print (s)

# escape double quote
s="Hello \"Python\""
print (s)

# escape \b to generate ASCII backspace
s='Hel\blo'
print (s)

# ASCII Bell character
s='Hello\a'
print (s)

# newline
s='Hello\nPython'
print (s)

# Horizontal tab
s='Hello\tPython'
print (s)

# form feed
s= "hello\fworld"
print (s)

# Octal notation
s="\101"
print(s)

# Hexadecimal notation
s="\x41"
print (s)

```

It will produce the following **output** –

This string will not include backslashes or newline characters.
 The \character is called backslash
 Hello 'Python'
 Hello "Python"
 Helo

```
Hello
Hello
Python
Hello Python
hello
world
A
A
```

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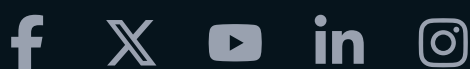
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